Centralized Email Policy

Effective Date:
November 13, 2025

Category:
Platform

Scheduled Review:
November, 2026

1. Authority

Executive Order 2016-06, Enterprise Information Technology Governance

2. Document Control

This policy replaces, in its entirety, the *Centralized Email Policy*, dated January 6, 2025.

3. Purpose

The purpose of this Information Technology Policy (ITP) is to establish that the Office of Administration, Office for Information Technology (OA/IT) maintains a centralized enterprise email system.

4. Scope

This policy applies to all offices, departments, boards, commissions, and councils under the Governor's jurisdiction and any other entity connecting to the Commonwealth Network (hereinafter referred to as "agencies").

5. Policy

For definitions of terms found within this document, refer to the *IT Policy Glossary*.

Agencies shall use the centralized email system for email communications.

Agencies utilizing the Commonwealth Metropolitan Area Network shall use the email filtering solution provided by the Commonwealth's Telecommunication Contract. This includes Agencies that have obtained an IT policy exception and are maintaining email servers that are not part of the Commonwealth active directory forest.

The centralized email system operations shall be managed by the Office of Administration, Office for Information Technology, Enterprise Technology Services Office (OA/OIT/ETSO).

There is no requirement for a Commonwealth email account to be assigned if an employee or

contracted resource does not require Commonwealth email services for their normal job duties.

5.1 Exchange Configurations and Basic Settings

IT Administrators shall follow guidance on usage limits, detailed at: https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/office365/servicedescriptions/exchange- online-service-description/exchange-online-limits

5.2 Email Message Size

IT Administrators across the Commonwealth shall configure the email message maximum size to thirty-five megabytes (35 MB). Agencies needing to share files larger than 35 MB are encouraged to use an alternate file sharing service (i.e. OneDrive). Exemptions may be requested where a business need exists. Agencies needing an exception to the maximum message size shall obtain an approved policy exception as detailed in section 7.

5.3 Personal Storage Table (PST) Requirement

IT Administrators across the Commonwealth shall deploy configurations that do not allow users to create nor open .PST files. Agency personnel who are required to utilize .PST files, due to business requirements, must obtain an approved IT policy exception. Exception requests shall include the Commonwealth personnel's CWOPA user ID. A business justification for allowing the creation of .PST files shall also be provided. Refer to Section 7 for guidance on the exception process.

5.4 Bulk Email

The use of the centralized email solution for bulk mail can negatively impact service, including the risk of being blacklisted as a spammer, which would also impact business email. Therefore, the centralized email system shall not be used to send bulk email. All bulk email must be distributed through an approved Commonwealth bulk email service. The following requirements shall also apply:

5.4.1 Subscribing and Opting Out

- All external mailing lists must use a double opt-in process to confirm recipient consent to receive such emails.
- All non-mandatory bulk communications shall include a clear and functional unsubscribe mechanism.
- Distribution lists shall be regularly reviewed and maintained to remove inactive, bounced, or unengaged addresses.

5.4.2 Content Standards

- Subject lines must be clear, accurate, and free of spam-associated terms, excessive capitalization, or repeated punctuation.
- Emails shall comply with industry standards for formatting and coding, including the provision of both HTML and plain-text versions.
- Attachments, Flash, JavaScript, and other non-standard code are prohibited in bulk email.
- All bulk emails shall include a valid physical address to support sender authentication and compliance with applicable regulations.

6. Contact

Questions or comments may be directed via email to OA, IT Policy.

7. Exception from Policy

In the event an agency chooses to seek an exception from this policy, a request for a policy exception shall be submitted via the IT policy exception process. Refer to *IT Policy Governance* for guidance.

8. Revision History

This chart contains a history of this publication's revisions. Redline documents outline the revisions and are available to Commonwealth users only during the drafting process.

Version	Date	Purpose of Revision
Original	01/06/2025	Base Document
Revision	11/13/2025	Updated to allow exceptions to the maximum message size where a business need exists. Added section regarding bulk email.